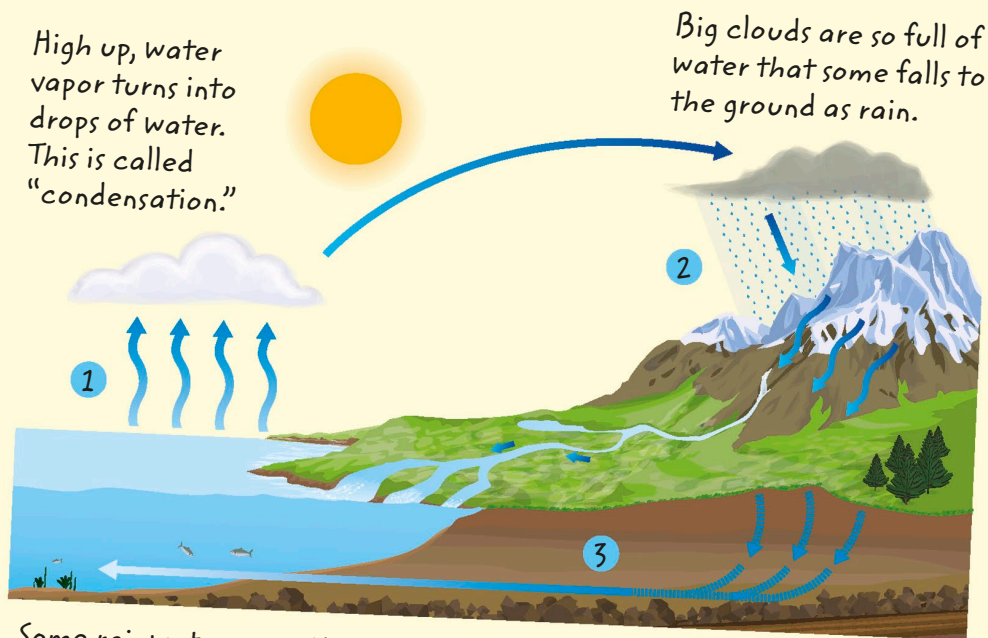


THE WATER CYCLE

Rain is the same water going around and around in a never-ending circle called the water cycle.



Some rainwater seeps through the ground before reaching rivers.

1. Damp air

Water gets into the air because the Sun heats up oceans and lakes. Millions of gallons of water then rise into the air as invisible water vapor. This is called "evaporation."

2. Falling rain

When some clouds get big, the droplets of water in them bump into each other and grow. They get so big that they fall to the ground as rain. This is called "precipitation."

3. Running away

Some rain falls straight into the sea. Rain falling on the ground fills up rivers and streams, which run back to the sea, then the cycle begins all over again.